

SCP Study - Essay Questions & Sample Answers

Review sheet for the essay portion of the course exam

These sample answers summarize the course material used by Essay Practice. The goal is to recall the named authorities, their held positions, and the important qualifications quickly and accurately.

ESSAY 1

נ"ט בר נ"ט - deliberate cooking

QUESTION

A parve food is deliberately cooked in a clean meat or dairy vessel with the intention of later adding the opposite type. Discuss the relevant opinions for a ben-yomo vessel and an eino-ben-yomo vessel, and include the dry-food-on-the-opposite-plate application.

SAMPLE ANSWER

For a ben-yomo vessel, Shach, Ben Ish Chai, and Kaf HaChaim forbid לכתחילה deliberately cooking the parve food when the plan is to add the opposite type, while Rav Ovadya permits לכתחילה. For an eino-ben-yomo vessel, Gra and Badei HaShulchan permit; Chochmat Adam and Rav Elyashiv initially forbid but allow when no other pot is available. Rav Moshe permits לכתחילה placing dry parve food cooked in a ben-yomo meat or dairy vessel onto a clean plate of the opposite type, while Pri Megadim dissents.

ESSAY 2

נ"ט בר נ"ט - when the model may fail

QUESTION

When does a transfer qualify as נ"ט בר נ"ט? Discuss the dispute over food-to-food transfer and the case where the original source and recipient are still cooking together.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Pri Megadim and Aruch HaShulchan do not count the first food-to-food transfer as נ"ט בר נ"ט; Pnei Aryeh and Rav Ovadya do, while Chavot Da'at and Yad Yehuda are intermediate. For an ongoing cooking connection, Chavot Da'at says the weakening has not yet occurred, Beit Ephraim says it can, Ashkenazic practice can rely on Beit Ephraim בדיעבד or for significant loss, and Rav Ovadya follows the lenient view.

ESSAY 3

Fish and meat - bitul and סכנה

QUESTION

Fish accidentally became mixed with meat. Discuss whether bitul applies to a סכנה mixture and what additional grounds for leniency the course gives when there is no ששים.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Maharil says bitul does not apply to סכנה, while Issur VeHeiter permits and the course follows the lenient practical custom. Without ששים after an accidental mixture, S"A's rule allowing added היתר to an accidental rabbinic mixture, Pitchei Teshuvah's question whether אין מבטלין governs סכנה, Magen Avraham's question whether the danger applies today, and Divrei Malkiel's extension to actual mixture are distinct possible tzirufim.

ESSAY 4

Dish transfer - simultaneous vessels, עירוי, and a continuous stream

QUESTION

Discuss the main disputes governing meat/dairy taste transfer in hot water: simultaneous clean ben-yomo vessels, עירוי onto dirty opposite dishes, and a continuous stream of hot parve soup into a cold opposite-type bowl.

SAMPLE ANSWER

S"A permits simultaneous clean ben-yomo meat and dairy vessels in hot parve water, while Rama forbids. For עירוי onto dirty opposite dishes, Rama permits and Shach forbids because עירוי can transfer קליפה כדי. For a continuous hot parve stream from a ben-yomo meat pot into a cold dairy bowl, Rama forbids the bowl while Shach permits it as ב"ט בר נ"ט. Ohr L'Tzion supplies an additional sink leniency by treating travel through pipes as weakening to כלי שני.

ESSAY 5

Soap and dishwashers

QUESTION

May one dishwasher be used sequentially for meat and dairy? Discuss the role of soap as פוגם, the major permissive opinions, and the concern raised by modern filters.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Piskei Uteshuvot raises a concern whether ordinary soap is sufficiently פוגם; Chazon Ish and Rav Forst give it substantial weight. Rav Moshe permits sequential use with separate racks, Rav Shmuel Tuvia Stern permits even with the same racks, and Rav Ovadya permits when the initial rinse is cold. Agurah B'Ohalecha cautions that modern filters can undermine older dishwasher analysis.

ESSAY 6

סַתֵּם יֵינֵם - why benefit was prohibited and the modern-non-Jew dispute

QUESTION

Why is benefit from סַתֵּם יֵינֵם prohibited, and how do the major opinions treat benefit today when ordinary non-Jews are not assumed to make wine libations? Include the practical S"A/Rama framework.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Beit Yosef explains the benefit ban by modeling סַתֵּם יֵינֵם on נִסְךְ; Ran connects it to preventing benefit from actual נִסְךְ; Rashba describes a later benefit decree after the original drinking decree. Rashi and the Geonim permit benefit today while drinking remains prohibited; Rosh distinguishes the non-Jew's own wine from Jewish wine touched by a non-Jew; Rambam keeps benefit prohibited in both. S"A follows Rambam, while Rama allows Geonic/Rashi reliance בדיעבד or for loss.

ESSAY 7

מְבוּשָׁל - ownership and pasteurization

QUESTION

A non-Jew owns kosher mevushal wine, and another case involves modern pasteurization of kosher wine. Discuss the major opinions on whether מְבוּשָׁל protects the wine in each situation.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Rosh, Ritva, and Ramban permit non-Jewish ownership of kosher mevushal wine on the 'not ordinary wine' logic; R. Akiva Eiger's analysis keeps the ownership decree, while the notes read S"A/Taz practically toward permission. On pasteurization, Shach, Ran, and Rashba emphasize heating with some evaporation; Rav Moshe and Rav Ovadya accept יד סולדת בו; R. Shlomo Zalman and others require a more meaningful cooking/evaporation change.

ESSAY 8

Sherry-cask whisky

QUESTION

A whisky is aged in a sherry cask. Discuss the major reasons to prohibit or permit it, including the amount needed for bitul, whether the sherry contributes positive flavor, and the issue of איסור לכתחילה.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Shach can require ששים against the absorbed wine/barrel thickness; S"A and Taz use a 1:6 measure against קליפה כדי. Rav Moshe describes the remnant as weakened קיוהא, while Mishna Halachot says the sherry prevents bad oak flavor rather than adding tasted wine flavor. For איסור מבתלין, the notes/key give a manufacture-for-non-Jews route and Rav Moshe's limitation for a rabbinic prohibition without a practical biblical libation root. Second-fill casks have more room because the retained taste is older/weaker.

ESSAY 9

Social drinking - beer, business drinks, and coffee

QUESTION

A Jew is invited to have drinks with non-Jews in several settings: ordinary beer, a business drink at a non-Jewish bar, and coffee at a coffee shop. Discuss the relevant opinions and distinctions.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Rama limits the beer decree so ordinary grain beer is outside it; Gra rejects that narrowing. Kaf HaChaim and Pri Chadash stress sporadic place and infrequency in the non-fixed case. For a business drink, S"A/Gra prohibit as the baseline, Rav Moshe allows room where refusal creates איבה, and Ohr L'Tzion remains cautious. Gra and Panim Meiros are among the stricter views on prestigious coffee-shop social drinking.

ESSAY 10

Social drinking - weddings and family celebrations

QUESTION

A Jew is invited to non-Jewish celebrations. Discuss the rules for drinking at a non-Jewish party or wedding, the role of איבה, and the special discussions of a Muslim wedding and a ger attending a family celebration.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Rambam forbids drinking even one's own kosher/mevushal wine at a non-Jewish party; S"A's wedding rule is especially strong. Taz rejects a general איבה waiver, while Shach records possible room rather than a categorical permission. Rav Ovadia permits a Muslim wedding because the idolatry dimension differs; Darchei Teshuva still invokes intermarriage/social concern; Shav V'Rafah permits a ger's family celebration in its circumstances.

ESSAY 11

Who can prohibit Jewish wine?

QUESTION

How does the identity of the person touching Jewish wine affect the ruling? Discuss the course's treatment of modern non-Jews, Muslims - including doubtful touch - and a public Shabbat desecrator.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Rama's 'non-Jews today' approach can downgrade some touch results; Shach often limits reliance especially to loss. Muslim touch retains a drinking concern but permits benefit, and Rav Ovadia permits drinking in doubtful Muslim-touch cases. The course separately teaches that wine touched by a public Shabbat desecrator can be forbidden to drink while benefit remains permitted.

ESSAY 12

What act of contact forbids the wine?

QUESTION

A non-Jew or nonreligious Jew handles Jewish wine in several ways: pouring, accidental touch, shaking an open bottle, or deliberately pouring the wine. Discuss the major opinions and practical qualifications for each act.

SAMPLE ANSWER

For pouring without full shaking, S"A prohibits drinking but permits benefit; Rama's downgrade can permit drinking, with Shach emphasizing reliance especially for loss. S"A similarly prohibits drinking after accidental touch while permitting benefit; Rama can be more lenient for today's non-Jews, with Shach more cautious without loss. On shaking an open bottle, S"A prohibits drinking and benefit while Rama permits on his downgrade. Rav Ovadya still forbids drinking after a Muslim's deliberate pour, and Rav Elyashiv treats a nonreligious Jew's pour as significant because pouring can function like shaking.

ESSAY 13

נצוק - the stream connection

QUESTION

Kosher wine is poured in a continuous stream into prohibited wine or prohibited residue. Discuss whether נצוק connects the source to the receiving wine, the significant-loss rule, and how mevushal status or ששים may affect the case.

SAMPLE ANSWER

Rashi and Rav Chisda treat נצוק as a connection, while Rabbeinu Tam does not. S"A and Rama allow reliance on the non-connection view in genuine significant loss. A mevushal source can still face the issue when poured into already-forbidden non-mevushal residue; sufficient ששים can provide a bitul route, though deliberately creating the ratio raises איסור לכתחילה.

ESSAY 14

Wine left with a non-Jew

QUESTION

Jewish wine is left with a non-Jew. Explain the rules for open wine left with an idolater or Muslim, when יוצא ונכנס works, and what kinds of seals or other protections can preserve the wine.

SAMPLE ANSWER

S"A prohibits open wine immediately when it is left alone with an idolater under the access conditions. For a Muslim, the course rule uses enough time to walk a mil, though Shach can be stricter where drinking itself is the concern. יוצא ונכנס depends on unpredictability of return and lack of visual/locking barriers; a fixed known schedule undermines it. Effective seals or other protections must create tamper evidence or credible fear of being caught.